Travel Agents: Taiwan — Rules (v6.3.1 · TICKETS-ONLY · balance-validated)

0. The pitch (read aloud)

"Rival travel agents build the best Taiwan food tour in one eating day. Ride between four regions to spread your name, dig ingredients, and pile Buzz on the vendors you want — but your hype can't outrun your Reach. Win a vendor by out-hyping your rival on the spot; each becomes a stop and makes the next cheaper. Points come only from Tour Tickets — finish them before dusk turns the street to the night market, and again before the last train. Most tour points is Top Agent."

1. Goal

Points come only from your Tour Tickets — your win-pile 成團 minus half your lose-pile 遺珠 (§9). Most = Top Agent. Vendors don't score — they're your engine and your tour stops (§5).

2. Setup (teach while you set up)

1. Unfold the Taiwan map: four regions in a ring (North 北 · Central 中 · South 南 · East 東), an HSR spine linking

North↔South. On it — the day-clock (a dusk and a last-train mark), the Tours Completed counter (Rave Review marks at your 2nd and 4th completed tour), the Reach track (your Buzz-cap, not a score), and per region a face-down vendor deck with face-up vendor slots (North 2, others 1) and a face-down ingredient market deck. Set each Tours Completed to 0 and each Reach to 2.

2. Split each region's cards into a DAY and a NIGHT deck (drinks are low-Draw vendors mixed into each); set the night decks aside for dusk. Shuffle the day vendor and day ingredient decks into place. Ingredient decks hold the 5-palette (N 豬肉 · C 茶 · S 海鮮 · E 米, plus common K 糖 in C & S only) and a few events (§6) — including the two 排班保養 "Scheduled Maintenance" cards, one in the North NIGHT and one in the South NIGHT ingredient deck. Fill the vendor slots. Set out the Buzz supply (~24 @2p).
3. Tour Tickets: shuffle the DAY deck, draw 5 (rest to the box), reveal 3 as the shared ticket row (the other 2 form its draw pile); set NIGHT aside, drawn likewise at dusk. A ticket's deck is its clock: DAY judged at dusk, NIGHT at the last train (§8–§9).
4. Each agent takes an Agent Character (ability + flaw, read aloud) and a pawn, and starts in Taipei (the North hub). If 里長伯 is in play, he names one home region now — his −1 discount applies only there, +1 ingredient to Bribe elsewhere (§5). Your Larder starts empty, face-up all game.

3. Your turn (teach these six, then just play)

Take ONE action. Then if your Larder exceeds 7, discard down to 7 (to that region's market discard, reshuffled when the deck runs dry — ingredients are never removed from the game).

- VISIT THE LOCAL MARKET (where you stand) — flip the top 3 of this region's ingredient deck; any event fires now by scope (§6), then discards. Keep up to 2. Greedy Grab: keep 1 more → −1 Reach (§4a).
- CONVENIENCE STORE (anywhere) — flip the top 1 of any region's ingredient deck: ingredient → take it; event → fires by scope (§6). Greedy Grab: take the next card too → −1 Reach (§4a).
- TRAVEL — move to a neighbour (HSR = North↔South), then flip the top 1 of the region you arrive in: ingredient → take it; event → nothing, keep moving. +1 Reach (§4).
- PROMOTE (with a vendor, in this region) — place 2 Buzz from the supply on vendor(s) you're with, keeping your total committed Buzz ≤ your Reach (§4). Buzz stays on the card, public; rivals may pile on too.
- BRIBE A VENDOR — win a face-up vendor by out-hyping your rival, on the spot (§4–§5).
- LINE UP A TOUR TICKET — take one from the face-up row of 3 (this phase's pool) as an open commitment, then refill. Only one you haven't yet completed. It scores later into your win/lose pile (§8–§9).

Agent Characters bend the rules. Each mat has **one ability + one flaw** for that agent alone — read them aloud at setup; a mat wins where it differs from the above.

4. Buzz & Reach — the hype fight

- Buzz sits only in the supply or on a vendor — never in your hand.
- To Buzz a vendor, stand in its region.
- Both agents can Buzz the same vendor.

Your hype can't outrun your Reach. Your **total committed Buzz may never exceed your current Reach** (a marker starting at 2; not a score). **Travel +1** and a few **events** raise it; **winning a vendor clears your Buzz off it**, freeing the cap. To out-escalate a contested vendor you first need the Reach to cover the stack.

4a. Reach sinks — the Greedy Grab

You may grab one extra ingredient beyond your limit (an extra keep on a Visit, or a second card on a Convenience Store) — each grab costs **−1 Reach**. A couple of events also cost Reach (a bad review, a mix-up).

The one edge-case rule (say it once): your committed Buzz can never exceed your Reach. So a **Greedy Grab you can't afford is simply not allowed** (take it only if it wouldn't drop your Reach

below your committed Buzz); and if an event drops your Reach below your committed Buzz, immediately return Buzz from the board to the supply — your choice which — until you're back within your cap. (Reach never goes below 0.)

5. Bribing a vendor — one rule for all

To Bribe a face-up vendor, all at once: 1. be with the vendor, in its region; 2. hold at least 2 more Buzz on it than your rival (the majority, checked right now); 3. pay its ingredients, minus your region discounts.

> 里長伯's home turf (his mat only). His −1 discount works only in his home region; Bribing anywhere else costs +1 ingredient of any one type. His mat carries both icons.

Take the vendor to your tour — now a stop and an engine piece. If it completes a Tour Ticket you hold, flip that ticket to its done side and advance your Tours Completed counter. Then clear ALL Buzz on it (yours and your rival's) to the supply — freeing your Reach cap — refill the slot, and move the day-clock +1 (§7). The vendor is locked from your rival.

A vendor card carries a Draw number (人氣) and either a region icon or none — no perks, and Draw is not a score. Draw only feeds the few Tour Tickets that ask for it (e.g. "vendors totalling ≥12 Draw") and marks the big prizes. Each region icon you hold makes that region's ingredients 1 cheaper on future vendors — the engine. Drinks and the apex ★ carry no icon; Buzz is never discounted. Night

stalls cost meaningfully more than day stalls, and every night name needs two regions' ingredients — so a one-region ramp helps you afford the big night names but never zeroes them. If your rival out-hypes you first, your Buzz fizzles back to the supply, you keep every ingredient you sourced, and you never seize a place.

> Rave Reviews (milestones · 好評). The first time YOU reach your 2nd completed tour → +1 Reach; the first time YOU reach your 4th → take 1 ingredient of your choice + your next Bribe costs 1 less ingredient. One-time each, and each agent earns their own (crossing a mark never pumps the leader).

6. Market decks & events

Each region's market is a face-down deck of its signature ingredient (+ the common K, in two of the four regions) and a few event cards (mostly hazards). Working a market — a Visit or a Convenience Store — fires any flipped event straight away, by its scope; a card flipped as you arrive on a Travel does nothing. - Hazards (the majority) tax or delay — never destroy what you hold, and never cost a whole turn. - Boons (the minority) hand out Buzz, or make a vendor get hot (★).

> The scope tag — who the event hits, read from the region the card came out of: ⦿ You (the flipper) · ⬢ This region (everyone standing there) · ➤ Next door (a neighbour). On a Visit you stand where you flipped, so ⬢ hits you; on a Convenience Store you're often elsewhere, so ⬢ hits whoever stands in the region you

flipped — so a scoped hazard can land on a rival. Never a personal attack — just the island living its life.

排班保養 "Scheduled Maintenance" (a table-wide event). An island-wide card (its own banner frame, not a ⦿/⬢/➤ card): the HSR is down for everyone. Place it on the HSR spine. Until the start of your next turn, North and South are not linked — everyone Travels the long way (N→C→S or N→E→S). Then discard it and the HSR reopens.

★ Star vendors. Some night-market names carry a printed ★ (a real Michelin / Bib-Gourmand nod), the top Draw, and no region icon (a pure trophy) — one apex per region. A boon can also drop a ★ Star token on a vendor, making it worth +2 Draw to whoever wins it.

7. The day-clock — Day → Night

It's one eating day. The day-clock climbs +1 every time anyone Bribes a vendor. Two marks (2p: dusk = the 5th table-wide vendor win · last train = the 10th; the marks grow with more players): - Act I — Daytime 白天: morning food + drinks; build your discount ramp. Daytime Tour Tickets are on offer. - DUSK (the day-clock hits the dusk mark). In one flip: judge every claimed DAYTIME ticket (completed → win-pile · unfinished → lose-pile — §9); then clear the entire day layer island-wide — every face-up and face-down day vendor deck and day ingredient deck — and reveal each region's night decks. Swap the ticket row to the nighttime pool. You keep your Larder. Any unclaimed day vendor is gone. - Act II — Night Market 夜市: the big stalls — expensive, fought-over, the ★ apex per region.

8. The last train home

When the day-clock hits the last-train mark (2p: the 10th vendor win), everyone catches the last train: finish the current round, play one more full round, and stop. (Backstop: if a region's deck empties, its slot isn't refilled until the next flip; if all decks dry island-wide, the phase ends then. If one win trips dusk and the last train at once, resolve dusk first, then the end check.)

9. Scoring

Your score is your Tour Tickets, and nothing else. Reveal both piles and tally once, at game end: - + the printed value of each ticket in your WIN pile (成團) — the tours that ran. - − floor(value ÷ 2) for each ticket in your LOSE pile (遺珠) — the ones that got away.

Tickets are sorted into your two piles as each phase ends (DAY at dusk, NIGHT at the last train — §7–§8); you tally once. Vendors do NOT score — each was your engine and a stop; its Draw was never points. Reach does NOT score. Most points wins → Top Agent. Ties: most vendors, then most regions covered, then fewest tickets in your LOSE pile (遺珠).

10. Warm-tone reminders (not rules)

- You're promoting Taiwan's food — winning a vendor is out-hyping your rival to earn a vendor's blessing, never taking from them. "Bribe" is the cheeky word; the deed is a warm hard sell, not corruption.
- Events are the island living its life — never sacred customs for laughs; a Convenience-Store event on your rival is the

island doing it, a shared groan, never a spiteful strike. Dish and vendor names stay real (Tâi-lô + 繁體); the comedy is the caper gag and your own gluttony.

Iconography — the flip-to legend

Every glyph on the cards, tokens, and board. Shapes are drawn, so they read by shape + 繁體 label, never colour alone.

Ingredients (the 5 tokens)

豬 **Pork 豬肉**
North signature · hexagon

茶 **Tea 茶**
Central signature · triangle

海 **Seafood 海鮮**
South signature · square

米 **Rice 米**
East signature · circle

糖 **Sugar 糖**
The common (C & S only) · beam

The four regions

北 **North 北**
vermilion · triangle · pork

中 **Central 中**
jade · diamond · tea

南 **South 南**
amber · circle · seafood

東 **East 東**
indigo · square · rice

Event scope — who it hits

⊙ **You**
self — only the flipper

⬢ **This region**
everyone standing in the drawn region

➤ **Next door**
spills into a neighbouring region

Day / Night



Day 日 · 早
warm morning layer — breakfast run



Night 夜 · 市
neon night-market layer (after dusk)

Currencies & scoring



Buzz 讚
the hype you pile on a vendor



★ Apex / Star
top prize per region; a Star adds value



Prestige
a vendor's point value (your score)



Reputation 譽
your standing — scores by final position

The two ticket piles

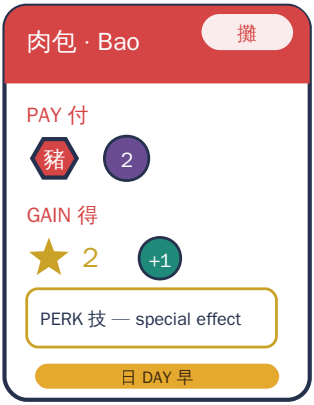


成團 · Win pile
tours that ran: gain printed value



遺珠 · Lose pile
got away: lose half the value

Vendor card — layout key



① Header band = region colour + emblem + dish name

② PAY 付 = ingredient chips (shape+繁體) + Buzz neede

③ GAIN 得 = Prestige (★) + Reputation (譽) + perk

④ PERK 技 = the vendor's special bonus

⑤ Phase ribbon = day 日 / night 夜 (which layer)

Top-right pill = venue tier (攤 stall · 小吃 · 名店)

★ printed = an apex / Star vendor (top prize)